IEAP-001 — Independent Evidence Acquisition Protocol

Status: FROZEN — MIP-001 W0 / W2 **Constitutional basis:** Articles 2, 4, 5, 28

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1. Purpose

IEAP governs how evidence enters VERIQO. Its central claim is narrow and defensible: **VERIQO can show what it acquired, from where, under what authority, and that the raw artifact was preserved before anything touched it.** It makes no claim that acquired content is true — Article 2.

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2. Acquisition flow

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Reverse Proof → Evidence Requirement → Source Eligibility
  → Rights Check → Independence Check → Neutral Selection
  → Connector → Raw Response → Hash → WORM
  → Manifest → Receipt → Evidence Version
```

The ordering is constitutional, not stylistic:

- **Rights check precedes connector contact** (Article 4). A rights failure means the network call never happens. A system that calls first and audits after has already violated the article regardless of what the audit says.
- **Hash and WORM precede manifest** (Article 5). A parsed representation that outlives its raw original is invalid evidence.
- **Independence check precedes neutral selection** so that source choice cannot be steered toward a same-root cluster.

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3. Fail-closed rules

Each is an unconditional refusal, not a warning:

Condition	Outcome
No rights	`NO_CONTACT` — connector is never invoked
Invalid certificate	`QUARANTINE`
Raw cannot be preserved	`ACQUISITION_FAIL` — the acquisition is void, not degraded
Hash mismatch	`INVALID`
Party-supplied credential	`PARTY_MEDIATED` — acquired, but marked non-independent
Unapproved connector	`DENY`
AI instructing a connector	`DENY` (Article 8)

`PARTY_MEDIATED` deserves emphasis: evidence obtained using a party's own credentials is still evidence, but it is **not independently acquired**, and it can never satisfy an independence requirement. The protocol records the distinction rather than discarding the artifact.

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4. Connector authority boundary

A connector **may**: contact an approved endpoint, use its designated credential, receive a response, write raw intake, emit an acquisition event.

A connector **may not**: access arbitrary vault objects, access another tenant's data, access unrelated credentials, modify policy, sign findings, modify evidence, invoke AI, browse arbitrary internet, or change qualification.

This is a capability boundary, not a code review guideline. A connector that could do any of the second list would make Articles 4 and 8 unenforceable.

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5. Three lineage dimensions

Provenance is not one chain. IEAP maintains three, and conflating them is how false independence claims arise:

1. **Source lineage** — provider → source artifact
2. **Acquisition lineage** — VERIQO acquisition → raw artifact
3. **Transformation lineage** — raw → normalization → observation → finding

```
Provider → Source Artifact → VERIQO Acquisition → Raw Artifact
  → Normalization → Observation → Finding
```

Every transition is hash-bound. Two artifacts may share transformation lineage while differing in source lineage, or vice versa — and only source-lineage divergence bears on independence.

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6. Acquisition receipt and manifest

The **receipt** attests to one acquisition event: what was requested, from which source, under which rights profile, at which logical time, producing which raw hash.

The **manifest** is the canonical, JCS-canonicalized record over which the manifest hash is computed and, where signing is enabled, signed.

Verification points, per MIP W3.2 — integrity is re-checked at each, not assumed to persist:

```
initial acquisition · vault transfer · before transformation
after transformation · before review · before analysis
before export · replay · restore · failover · periodic audit
```

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7. WORM vault requirements

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Object versioning · Retention lock · Legal hold · Encryption
CMEK/KMS · Signed manifests · Access control · Custody history
Cross-region backup · External checkpoint
```

Four distinctions the vault must keep separate:

```
Immutable   ≠ Accessible
Restricted  ≠ Deleted
Legal Hold  ≠ Privilege
WORM        ≠ Truth
```

The last is the one that matters commercially. A WORM vault proves an artifact has not changed since it was stored. It says nothing whatever about whether the artifact was true when stored.

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8. Current implementation status

Per MIP §34 taxonomy:

Component	Status
Evidence manifest + custody FSM	`IMPLEMENTED`, `ADVERSARIAL_TESTED` (`pkg/evidence/manifest`, FROZEN)
Hash / canonicalization	`IMPLEMENTED`, `REPLAY_VERIFIED` (`pkg/canonical/jcs`)
Retention / legal hold	`IMPLEMENTED`, `INTEGRATION_TESTED` (`pkg/governance/data`)
Acquisition contracts	`IMPLEMENTED` with **simulated** sources (`pkg/connector/*`)
Rights-before-contact gate	`DESIGNED` — the rule is constitutional and checked in `pkg/constitution`; no live connector currently performs a real acquisition to gate
WORM vault	`DESIGNED` — retention lock and legal hold exist; object-store WORM binding does not
Independent attestation	`DESIGNED` — external dependency

No live provider integration exists in any domain. Every connector emits `ModeSynthetic` and has no code path capable of producing `ModeLive` — enforced by type, not convention. See `docs/VERIQO_REAL_WORLD_NETWORK_MODEL.md`.